

Distance Learning — Credit Transfer Guidelines

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These guidelines explain how credits earned through distance learning are evaluated, accepted and recorded for transfer between institutions. They support the Distance Learning and Remote Education Policy and are intended for institutional registrars, academic advisors and students.

1. Introduction

Distance learners often move between institutions for personal or professional reasons. A transparent credit transfer process helps them continue their studies without undue loss of progress or unnecessary repetition. These guidelines describe the principles, process and documentation involved.

2. Purpose

The purpose of these guidelines is to set common expectations so that credit transfer decisions are fair, consistent and defensible, while respecting the academic autonomy of institutions to set admission and progression standards.

3. Scope

These guidelines apply to the transfer of credits between distance learning programmes, and between distance and campus-based programmes where the credit system and learning outcomes are comparable. They do not apply to exemptions granted on the basis of prior learning not evidenced by institutional credit.

4. Principles

- Transparency: students must be informed, before or at enrolment, of the institution's credit transfer policy.
- Equivalence: credits are accepted on the basis of learning outcomes and volume of learning, not solely on programme name.
- Fairness: decisions are made against published criteria and within defined timeframes.
- Academic autonomy: the receiving institution makes the final decision on acceptance, guided by its own academic standards.

- Documentation: all transfer decisions are recorded and open to audit.

5. Eligibility

- The student must have completed the relevant modules with a pass or above, as appropriate to the receiving institution's requirements.
- The source institution must be recognised and the programme from which credits are transferred must be approved.
- The credits to be transferred must fall within the limits set by the receiving institution.
- Credits must not have been used towards another qualification at the same level.

6. Process Overview

1. The student applies to the receiving institution with transcripts, course descriptions and any required supporting documents.
2. The receiving institution acknowledges receipt and assigns a reference within five working days.
3. An academic assessor maps the source modules to receiving programme requirements and prepares an equivalence report.
4. The assessor recommends acceptance, conditional acceptance or rejection for each module.
5. The recommendation is reviewed and approved by the relevant programme committee or equivalent authority.
6. The student is notified of the decision, and accepted credits are recorded in the student's record.

7. Credit Equivalence

Source Credit System	Equivalence Rule	Notes
Standard semester credits	1:1, subject to learning outcomes match	Default equivalence where systems align
Quarter credits	1 quarter credit = 0.67 semester credits	Adjusted for term length
Contact hours (non-credit modules)	15 contact hours = 1 credit, subject to content review	Used only where modular credits not defined
National qualification framework levels	Level match required; credit amount reviewed by assessor	Used for cross-framework cases

8. Limits and Conditions

Receiving institutions may set a maximum proportion of credits that may be transferred, typically not exceeding half of the programme total. The decision must be communicated to the student before registration where possible. Where credits are accepted conditionally, the conditions must be specific and time-bound.

9. Documentation Required

- Official transcript from the source institution.
- Module syllabi or learning outcomes for each module to be transferred.
- Proof of programme approval and accreditation at the source institution.
- Any supplementary documentation requested by the receiving institution's assessment guide.

10. Timelines

Action	Expected Timeframe
Acknowledgment of application	Within 5 working days
Equivalence assessment	Within 15 working days of receiving complete application
Notification of decision to student	Within 20 working days of assessment completion
Record update	Within 5 working days of decision notification

11. Appeals

A student may appeal a credit transfer decision within 15 working days of notification. The appeal must be in writing, stating the grounds and including any additional evidence. The institution must respond within 20 working days. Appeals are handled by an officer or committee not involved in the original decision.

12. Contact and Support

Students should contact the receiving institution's admissions or registrar's office for credit transfer queries. Institutions may seek advice from the Higher Education Department's academic standards cell on complex cases or policy interpretation.